THE CLUB

by Molly Baz

Grated Zucchini and Pistachio Pizza

SERVES: 4-6

Did'ya know? Zucchini is 95% water. You'll see for yourself (and reap the benefits of getting rid of it) when squeezing the bejesus out of the zucchini shreds in this recipe. The reward? Straight-up delicious, totally unsoggy zucch-heavy pie, all jumbled up with a ton of mint, 'chovies, scallions, mozz, and ricotta. Finish it all up with a shower of pistachios and there you have it: green on green.

ACTIVE TIME: 55 MINS
TOTAL TIME: 1 HR 20 MINS

PRODUCE

- 3 pounds zucchini (5-6 medium)
- 1 bunch scallions
- 1 large bunch mint

PANTRY

- Kosher salt and freshly ground black pepper
- 3 anchovies
- ⅓ cup raw, shelled pistachios
- Red pepper flakes
- All-purpose flour, for dusting baking sheet and forming pizza
- Olive oil, for drizzling and serving
- White wine vinegar, for serving

DAIRY

- 6 ounces mozzarella
- 5 ounces (½ cup) fresh ricotta
- Parmigiano-Reggiano, for grating and serving

MISC.

- One (1- to 1 ¼-pound) ball pizza dough

1. SET YOURSELF UP:

- Pull a 1- to 1 ¼-pound ball pizza dough from the fridge and let it come to room temp on the counter while you prep.
- Position a rack in the lower third of the oven and preheat to 500 degrees (or 550, if your oven goes that high). Place a pizza stone or an overturned sheet pan on the rack.

2. DO SOME PREP:

- On the large holes of a box grater or in a food processor fitted with the grater

attachment, shred 3 pounds zucchini and transfer to a large colander set over a bowl. Toss with 2 tablespoons salt and let sit until zucchini is leeching its water, at least 20 minutes and up to 2 hours in advance.

- Now grate 6 ounces mozzarella on the box grater (no need to wash). Chop 3 anchovies and 1 bunch scallions. Roughly chop enough leaves to measure ½ cup (lightly packed) from 1 large bunch mint and add to a large bowl, along with the mozz, anchovies, scallions, and the wrung-out zucchini shreds.
- Finely chop ⅓ cup raw pistachios and reserve for serving.

3. WRING OUT THE ZUCCHINI AND FINISH THE TOPPING:

- Give a few preliminary squeezes with your hands to expel some water from the zucchini and the shreds to a large kitchen towel. Twist into a ball and squeeze out as much liquid as you can. (Just when you think you've finished, squeeze some more.)
- Add the shreds to the bowl with the cheese mixture and stir to combine. Season to taste with salt, black pepper, and red pepper flakes.

4. BUILD THE PIZZA:

- Generously flour the back of an overturned large rimmed baking sheet (or a pizza peel). With floured hands, stretch the dough to an approximately 9- x 15-inch rectangle (or a round, if using a circular pizza stone) and place it on the baking sheet. Give the pan a shake to make sure the dough is mobile and not sticking, and continue to do so from time to time as you build the pizza. If the dough doesn't shake freely, it'll be impossible to slide it onto the baking sheet or pizza stone in the oven.
- Spread about three-quarters of the topping onto the dough in an even layer, leaving a 1-inch border for the crust. Dollop ½ cup fresh ricotta in spoonfuls over the top and finish with the remaining topping, covering the ricotta here and there. Generously drizzle the whole pie with olive oil, including the crust, and grate Parmigiano-Reggiano over the whole thing. (Avoid getting olive oil on the pan or the dough will stick.)

5. BAKE + SERVE:

- Give one final shake to the pan to make sure the dough will slide off. (If a certain spot is sticking, lift up the edge and toss some flour underneath to get it moving.)
- Open the oven door. Starting from the back of the pizza stone or sheet pan, slide and shake the pizza off of whatever you built it on in one swift movement so that the dough releases onto the stone or pan in the oven.
- Bake until the crust is golden on the edges and crisped on the bottom (take a peek

under the pizza with a bit metal spatula), about 15-22 minutes, depending on your oven temperature.

- Remove from the oven and top with the chopped pistachios, a final drizzle of olive oil, a grating of parm, more red pepper flakes, and ripped mint leaves. For the finishing zing, pour some white wine vinegar into a spoon and distribute over the top, repeating as needed to hit every quadrant.
- Cut into pieces and serve it upppp!

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